

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 6  
♥ A 7 3  
♦ K 4 3  
♣ A 10 9 6

♠ A 4

♥ K J 9 8

♦ 9 8 7 2

♣ K Q 5



♠ J 10 8 5 2

♥ 5 4

♦ A Q 10 6

♣ 3 2

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 10 6 2

♦ J 5

♣ J 8 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

All Pass

2 ♥ by South

Lead: ♥3

You dealt this hand.

With 13 points you will open. You cannot bid 1 ♥ with only 4 of them, so you say 1 ♦. Partner responds 1 ♥ and it is your bid again.

Partner's response is forcing. He might have anywhere from 6 points to about 17. With a minimum opener and 4-card support for his Major suit you bid 2 ♥. Partner passes.

**Board 2**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8  
 ♥ 8 7 5 3 2  
 ♦ A 7 6 4  
 ♣ J 8

♠ A Q J 5  
 ♥ K J 4  
 ♦ K 10 5 3  
 ♣ 7 2



♠ K 10 4 3  
 ♥ A 10  
 ♦ Q 8  
 ♣ K 10 5 4 3

♠ 7 6 2  
 ♥ Q 9 6  
 ♦ J 9 2  
 ♣ A Q 9 6

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1♦    | Pass | 1NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 1NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥7     |       |      |       |

So you pass and hope for the best.

You dealt this hand.

You are not strong enough to open 1NT, but too strong to pass. You bid 1♦. Partner responds 1NT. What do you say next?

You are not strong enough to open 1NT, but too strong to pass. You bid 1♦. Partner responds 1NT. What do you say next?

With that small doubleton in ♣s it is very tempting to rescue partner from 1NT by bidding 2♠. There are three good reasons why you don't. First, bidding 1♦ followed by 2♠ is a **REVERSE**, which shows a strong hand, perhaps 16-17 points or more. Second, and even more important, partner's 1NT bid **DENIES** a 4-card Major suit. And third, partner probably has something in ♣s since he has no 4-card Major and also didn't feel like supporting your ♦s.

**Board 3**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 10 2  
 ♥ 6 3  
 ♦ A K 10 6 4  
 ♣ J 9 2

♠ A K 9 7

♥ A Q J 5

♦ 5

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ Q 8 4

♥ 10 9 4

♦ Q J 9 2

♣ 10 7 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ K 8 7 2

♦ 8 7 3

♣ K Q 5

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♦ K

You dealt this hand.

The ♥ and ♠ suits look really good, but neither of them are 5 cards, so you open 1 ♣. Partner responds 1 ♥. What is your next bid?

Partner's bid shows 6-10 points and at least 4 ♥s. Since you now know there is an 8-card Major suit fit you revalue your hand, adding 2 more points for the singleton ♦.

That gives you 20 points; add partner's 6-10 and you have enough for game. She who knows, goes, so you bid 4 ♥.

**Board 4**

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 2  
♥ K Q J 4 2  
♦ J 10 3  
♣ J 6 4

♠ A 10 9 7

♥ 7 5

♦ A K

♣ A 10 8 3 2



♠ Q 3

♥ 10 9 3

♦ Q 9 8 6 5

♣ K Q 7

♠ K 8 6 5 4

♥ A 8 6

♦ 7 4 2

♣ 9 5

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|      | 1♣    | Pass | 1♠    |
| Pass | 3♠    | Pass | 4♠    |

All Pass

4♠ by South

Lead: ♥K

You dealt this hand.

You have the right strength but the wrong distribution to open 1NT. So you bid 1♣. Partner responds 1♠. What do you say next?

With partner's ♠ bid giving you a fit, your hand revalues to 18 points. If partner has only 6 or 7 points there is not enough for game, but if he has more than that then you should bid game.

When you are in-between like this you just invite. So you jump to 3♠. This tells partner to bid game if he has more than the minimum for his bid. He has 9 revalued points, so he bids 4♠.

**Board 5**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6 5 2  
♥ A 8 7 5 4  
♦ J 9 7  
♣ 4

♠ K J 10 8

♥ Q J 9 6

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 9



♠ 9 4

♥ 2

♦ Q 8 3 2

♣ J 8 7 6 5 3

♠ Q 7 3

♥ K 10 3

♦ K 10 4

♣ A Q 10 2

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥5

You dealt this hand.

This is the one situation when you open a 3-card ♦ suit; two 4-card Majors, three ♦s and two ♣s, but not enough strength to open 1NT.

Partner responds 2NT.

Partner's bid shows 13-16 points, balanced. And most importantly, it denies holding a 4-card Major suit. So you do not consider bidding either your ♥s or ♠s, but just bid 3NT.